such meetings, we went back and forth several times, and even after nearly five hours, I was not certain I had convincingly made my points to the committee.

As the meeting was closing, I told the committee that the ultimate defence against malpractices and fraud was greater public awareness. I told them that I would review the Reserve Bank's approach to financial literacy and see how it could be expanded and improved. I also told them that we would streamline our training of grass-root police and bank personnel about frauds and malpractices. Finally, I offered that the Reserve Bank would take the initiative to come out with a comprehensive list of FAQs and put it up on our website. Some members thought this response was too non-specific and inadequate compared to the severity of the problem. One member even ridiculed my suggestion of FAQs by asking whether it was realistic to expect semi-literate villagers to go to the Reserve Bank's website to understand the NBFC sector. I could relate to that criticism. I assured the committee that we would translate all the material into vernacular languages and work with state governments to disseminate that knowledge widely and deeply.

The result of this assurance was a comprehensive and exhaustive list of FAQs on the NBFC sector, the first of its kind for any sector or activity within the Reserve Bank's mandate. As per my assurance to the standing committee, we also translated the material into local languages for dissemination across the country. I must admit though that as all these developments took place in the closing months of my tenure, I did not have the time or the mind space, given my almost total preoccupation with rupee tantrums, to follow them through. But I am happy to note that the Reserve Bank has carried the action plan forward in all its dimensions.

In line with the 'every cloud has a silver lining' viewpoint, a positive outcome of the Saradha scam has been the tightening of the vigil at the field level on fraudulent schemes, fly-by-night operators and unauthorized deposit mobilization. In fact, as far back as in 1999, the Reserve Bank enjoined state governments to constitute state-level coordination committees (SLCCs) comprising relevant government officials, police and